



Discussion Guide: Roger Nam

Money, Wealth, and the Bible

Reflect

- How have you heard money and wealth talked about in your experience with the church or other faith communities? Did the topic come up often? What assumptions were made about God's relationship to human wealth?
- In his earthly life, Jesus was very poor and likely homeless. In your view, why is it significant that the Son of God became incarnate in the form of someone who was poor and homeless?
- Roger notes that the invention of money transformed the economy of ancient Israel, leading to benefits but also problems, such as greed and hoarding. In today's world, what is an aspect of the economy that can be used for good but can also lead to economic injustice? What values or perspectives can help you navigate this tension?

Respond

- The term "prosperity gospel" refers to the idea that God's favor manifests in material and financial success. Based on Roger's talk, what biblical arguments might be made in support of this idea? What arguments could you make against it? Do you believe material success is ever a reflection of God's favor? Why or why not?
- Jesus says, "Blessed are you who are poor, for yours is the kingdom of God," (Luke 6:20) and "How hard it is for the rich to enter the kingdom of God!" (Luke 18:24). Given the ideas Roger explores in his talk, how would you make sense of these two statements? How might riches get in the way of following God?